Where You Are: The Care Needs Step and What Comes After It

The nine steps of the Family Care Roadmap, with yours marked.

When a parent suddenly needs more help, everything seems to need deciding at once. It doesn't. There's an order to it, and you're near the beginning.

This page shows the whole road, where you are on it, and what comes next.

Phase 1 · Care Assessment

Understand the person, the family, and the situation.

1 **Discover** Current Situation → Concerns & Challenges → Goals & Priorities
You finish with: Family Discovery Summary

2 **Assess** Health & Function → Safety & Support → Lifestyle & Preferences
You finish with: Personal Care Assessment Summary

You are here. This step is about understanding what Mom can do today and where she already gets help. You finish it with her current abilities, the help in place, where your information came from and your open questions written down, ready for a professional to review.

3 **Define Needs** Needs & Risks → Care Requirements → Priorities & Recommendations
You finish with: Care Needs Profile and Immediate Action Roadmap

Phase 2 · Care Planning

Determine what good care should look like and prepare to put it in place.

4 **Explore Options** Care Setting → Provider/Facility Fit → Selection & Decision
You finish with: Care Options Comparison and Decision Record

5 **Build the Plan** Health & Personal Care → Daily Life & Quality of Life → Monitoring & Response
You finish with: Personal Care Proposal, Good Day Plan, and Monitoring Plan

6 **Prepare the Transition** Preparation → Move & Admission → Continuity of Care
You finish with: Transition Preparation Pack and Confirmed Handoff Log

Phase 3 · Care Management

Coordinate the plan, review what happens, and prepare the family to take the lead.

7 **Coordinate** People & Responsibilities → Communication & Handoffs → Care-Plan Alignment
You finish with: Care Team Plan and Care-Plan Alignment Record

8 **Monitor** Monitor → Identify & Escalate → Review & Adjust
You finish with: Care Review Dashboard and Concern/Change Logs

9 **Hand Off** Educate → Empower → Support
You finish with: Family Care Management Playbook and Handoff/Support Plan

What this step produces

A written picture of how Mom is doing day to day: her own account, what the family has seen, the care information you were given, and the questions that are still open. It is a family's notes, organized. It isn't an assessment.

What happens next

Two more topics finish this step: what helps keep Mom safe where she is, and her own preferences about how she lives. The picture you build now is what both of them start from. After that, the step called Define Needs turns the picture into a statement of what care has to cover.

Who is involved, by role

- You and your family: observing, gathering, writing down.
- Mom: her own account of what she can do and where she wants help.
- Her clinicians (doctor, nurse, pharmacist, therapist): the clinical questions, and what anything means medically.
- A care consultant: meets Mom as well as talking with the family, reviews the picture, and helps plan what comes next. The National Institute on Aging describes this kind of professional, often called a geriatric care manager, as someone who works with older adults and their families to identify needs, make a care plan and find services.

What this page doesn't promise

How long any step takes, who will be available, or how things turn out. Families move through the steps at different speeds.

Ready for the next step?

You know where you are and what comes next. The care interview is how you finish this step: it walks you through Mom's situation area by area and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Family Care Roadmap's own. The description of a geriatric care manager is the National Institute on Aging's.

1. National Institute on Aging, Services for Older Adults Living at Home